

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.30. 4th September 2023



WITHIN AND WITHOUT (Series No 2)

1. THE WALLS OF THE TEMPLE (the house of God) WERE DECORATED WITHIN and WITHOUT – (the Inner and Outer rooms).

1 Kings 6:29 On the walls all around the temple, IN BOTH the INNER and OUTER ROOMS, he carved cherubim, palm trees and open flowers. NIV

1 Kings 6:29 And he carved all the walls of the house roundabout with carved figures of cherubims and palm trees and open flowers, WITHIN and WITHOUT. KJV

- ▼ Architecturally it was designed that the inner AND the outer rooms contained both the heavenly and the earthy aspects of GOD'S MESSAGE FOR MAN – AND
- ▼ Also, it pictures CHRIST'S DIVINITY and CHRIST'S HUMANITY – Christ as the SON OF GOD and as the SON OF MAN – EQUALLY and PERFECTLY BLENDED TOGETHER.
- ▼ IN GOD'S HOUSE THERE MUST BE PRESENT "THE HEAVENLY" (Cherubim's) AND THE "EARTHLY"/ THE PRACTICAL (Palm trees/ open flowers) SO THAT IT IS REPRESENTED PERFECTLY AND COMPLETELY TO THE WORLD
- ▼ IN THE CHURCH (God's house) WE AS GOD'S SERVANTS SHOULD ALSO MAKE CERTAIN THAT THE MESSAGE OF BOTH THE HEAVENLY AND THE EARTHLY ASPECTS ARE PERMANENTLY PRESENT AND ACTIVELY PRESENTED.
- ▼ ONLY WHEN THESE TWO ASPECTS OF THE CHURCH'S MESSAGE ARE PRESENT AND PRESENTED IS THE CHURCH TRULY REPRESENTING WHAT GOD INTENDED HIS CHURCH TO BE TO THE WORLD.
- ▼ WHEN THE MESSAGE IS EMBRACED AND PROCLAIMED BOTH THE HEAVENLY SIDE OF SALVATION AND THE EARTHLY RESPONSIBILITY UPON THE CHURCH TO PROCLAIM AND TEACH THAT ALL THOSE WHO HAVE RECEIVED SALVATION ARE TO LIVE GODLY LIVES.
- ▼ THIS WOULD MAKE THE CHURCH'S MESSAGE TO BE BOTH COMPLETE IN CONTENT AND IN PRACTICE.

2. GOD AT WORK (WITHIN) SAVING US AND THEN WE ARE TO WORK OUT THE SALVATION –

- ▼ WE ARE TO WORK OUT WHAT GOD HAS WORKED WITHIN US

Philippians 2:13 [Not in your own strength] for it is God Who is all the while effectually at work in you [energizing and creating in you the power and desire], both to will and to work for His good pleasure and satisfaction and delight. AMP

Philippians' 2:12 Dearest friends, you were always so careful to follow my instructions when I was with you. And now that I am away you must be even more careful to put into action God's saving work in your lives, obeying God with deep reverence and fear. NLT

- ▼ GOD'S WORK (WITHIN) US WAS ENERGIZING US WITH POWER AND ABILITY TO CARRY OUT (WITHOUT) HIS WILL ON EARTH – AND ALSO
- ▼ AT THE SAME TIME CREATING (WITHIN) US DESIRE SO THAT WE REALLY WANTED TO CARRY OUT HIS WORK (WITHOUT) ON EARTH.
- ▼ THIS IS WHAT MAKE GOD'S WORK IN US COMPLETE AND NOTHING COULD BE ADDED TO. WE WERE ENERGIZED WITH DIVINE ABILITY AND ALSO WITH THE WILLINGNESS TO CARRY OUT HIS WILL ON EARTH.

3. BE IN HEALTH (WITHOUT) AS YOUR SOUL PROSPERS (WITHIN).

3 John 2 Dear friend, I pray that you may enjoy good health and that all may go well with you, even as your soul is getting along well. NIV

3 John 2 Beloved, I wish above all things that thou mayest prosper and be in health, even as thy soul prospereth. KJV

- ▼ THE SOUL (WITHIN) NEEDS TO BE DOING WELL SO THAT THE BODY (WITHOUT) WILL ALSO BE WELL.

4. GOD PRESERVES THE BODY (WITHOUT) SOUL & SPIRIT (WITHIN).

1 Thessalonians 5:23 May the God of peace himself make you entirely pure and devoted to God; and may your spirit and soul and body be kept strong and blameless until that day when our Lord Jesus Christ comes back again. TLB

5. GUARD WHAT IS WITHIN (THE HEART) SO THAT THE OUTCOMES OF LIFE – (WITHOUT) WILL RIGHTLY FOLLOW.

Proverbs 4:23 Above all else, guard your heart, for it is the wellspring of life. NIV

Proverbs 4:23 Above all else, guard your affections. For they influence everything else in your life. TLB

- ▼ GIVING PROPER ATTENTION TO DEVELOPING RIGHT ATTITUDES AND MOTIVES IN THE HEART.
- ▼ THEN DO ALL YOU CAN TO KEEP AND PROTECT THE HEART FREE FROM ALL THOSE NEGATIVE AND DESTRUCTIVE FORCES THAT DELIBERATELY TARGET THE HEART.
- ▼ SO, WE MIGHT LIVE RIGHTLY AS GOD INTENDED.

6. MAKING SURE THAT THE GRACE AND POWER OF THE CROSS HAS REACHED OUR INWARD PARTS OF OUR LIVES (WITHIN), SO THAT OUR OUTWARD BEHAVIOUR (WITHOUT) HAS BEEN TRULY TRANSFORMED INTO GODLY LIVING.

- ▼ DON'T BE A HALF-BAKED CAKE – like Ephraim
Hosea 7:8 "My people mingle with the heathen, picking up their evil ways; thus they become as good-for-nothing as a half-baked cake! TLB
Hosea 7:8 "Ephraim mixes with the nations; Ephraim is a flat cake not turned over. NIV
- ▼ EVEN THOUGH EPHRAIM WAS A PART OF GOD'S PEOPLE (ISRAEL) THE TRUTH AND GRACE OF GOD'S WORD HAD NOT PENETRATED TO THE INNER PARTS OF HIS LIFE.
- ▼ AND HIS MIXING WITH THE HEATHEN NATIONS AND ADOPTING SOME OF THEIR PRACTICES GAVE HIM A FORM, AN OUTWARD APPEARANCE OF GODLINESS, LIKE THAT OF A LOAF OF BREAD PREMATURELY TAKEN FROM THE BAKERS OVEN WHICH WAS NOT BAKED THROUGH AND THROUGH.
- ▼ LET US BE A PEOPLE WHO ALLOW THE TRUTH AND GRACE OF GOD TO TOUCH THE INWARD PARTS OF OUR LIVES, SO THAT WE MIGHT BE FULL AND COMPLETE ACCORDING TO THE STAGE OF OUR GROWTH IN THE LORD WITH GRACE AND TRUTH.
- ▼ **Colossians 1:6** "..... Just as in the entire world this gospel is bearing fruit and growing, so it has also been bearing fruit and growing among you from the first day you heard it and understood the grace of God in truth. NET
- ▼ DON'T BE A HALF BAKED CAKE

Amen – Ps Barry